

FROM GREATNESS TO BETRAYAL

Alberta's Public Fall from Grace

1979 — 2026

A Cross-Party Record of What Was Built, and What Was Taken

PHASE NINE

Synthesis

What The Forty-Seven Years Establish

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown

St. Albert, Alberta • May 2026

Synthesis — What The Forty-Seven Years Establish

Eight chapters. Eight Alberta governments. Forty-seven years of documented record. The trajectory across the whole of it is downward. The closing argument of this piece begins not with a thesis but with what the documented record itself has established, era by era, decision by decision, in the preceding chapters.

Peter Lougheed founded the assured-income-for-the-severely-handicapped program on January 1, 1979. He died on September 13, 2012, in the Calgary hospital that bears his name. Between his founding act and his death he served fourteen years as Premier of Alberta and twenty-seven years out of office. During the twenty-seven years he spent out of office, every successor government — Don Getty's PCs, Ralph Klein's PCs, Ed Stelmach's PCs, Alison Redford's PCs, Dave Hancock's interim PC government, Jim Prentice's PCs, Rachel Notley's NDP, Jason Kenney's UCP, and the current Danielle Smith UCP — has, on the documented record this piece has constructed, contributed in varying degrees to the dismantling of the structure Lougheed built. Some contributions were larger than others. Some were partial restorations rather than reductions. The trajectory across the whole of it is downward.

This synthesis chapter does five things:

- Lays out the comparative trends across all eight eras — AISH rate vs. inflation, caseload, appeal rights — in tables that allow the reader to see the trajectory at a glance.
- States the document's thesis in full, with the evidentiary weight of the preceding eight chapters behind it.
- Names why partisan-aligned advocacy has failed and will continue to fail.
- Makes the case for community-led, party-independent representation as the only structural protection available to the disability community.
- Closes with a direct invitation to the reader — to every disabled Albertan, every family member, every ally, every elected representative who has read this far — to join the work the ADSB campaign exists to construct.

The Comparative Trends, 1979 – 2026

Three structural dimensions of the AISH program have changed across the forty-seven years this document covers: the base rate (and its real-term purchasing power against inflation), the caseload (the population served), and the appeal rights (the structural protection from administrative error or arbitrary decision). The tables below summarise each dimension. Sources for every cell are documented in the phase chapters.

AISH Base Rate Trajectory, 1979 – 2026

The defining single metric of Alberta disability income policy. The structural shifts the table records are: the 1993 Klein-era freeze that compounded for over a decade; the modest 2007 Stelmach restoration that did not reach 1993 real-term parity; the 2012 Redford rate increase that held until 2019; the 2018 Notley statutory CPI indexation; the 2019 Kenney suspension; the 2023 Smith re-indexation capped at 2% below actual CPI; and the 2026 ADAP transition that reduces the underlying base rate structurally below the post-2018 starting point.

Year	Government	AISH Base Rate	Real-term gap vs 1979	Structural Note
1979	Lougheed PC	Senior-parity	Baseline	AISH founded as assured income, separate from welfare, pegged to senior pension rates. No asset limits.
1985	Lougheed/Getty PC	Maintained	Baseline maintained	Lougheed retires; program operating as designed.
1992	Getty PC (end of)	Maintained	Minor real-term drift	Heritage Fund halt (1987) compromises long-term fiscal model. AISH itself not directly cut.
1993	Klein PC	\$850/mo	Frozen — gap begins to widen	Klein-era freeze begins. Services for people with disabilities cut back.
2004	Klein PC	\$850/mo	11 years of freeze; ~30% real-term loss	"Severely normal" remarks during October 2004 campaign. Late-era partial adjustment follows.
2007	Stelmach PC	\$1,088/mo	Kneebone: still below 1993 real-term	First meaningful Klein-era restoration. The Stelmach increase did not reach 1993 real-term value.
2011	Stelmach PC (end)	\$1,188/mo	Approaching 1993 real-term	End-of-Stelmach rate; Klein-era purchasing power partially restored but not exceeded.
2012	Redford PC	\$1,588/mo	Above 1993 real-term	Last PC-era adjustment. Rate held at this level until 2019.
2019 (Jan)	Notley NDP	\$1,685/mo	Indexed by statute	NDP Bill 26 (2018) raises rate and indexes to CPI. The only time AISH has been indexed by statute.
2019 (Nov)	Kenney UCP	\$1,685/mo	Indexation suspended	Bill 20 (Fiscal Measures and Taxation Act) suspends CPI indexation. Definition of "severe handicap" moved to regulation.

Year	Government	AISH Base Rate	Real-term gap vs 1979	Structural Note
2022 (Oct)	Kenney UCP (end)	\$1,685/mo	3 years frozen — gap widens again	Three-year freeze concludes. ~\$209.8M total fiscal capture by suspension.
2023	Smith UCP	~\$1,719/mo	Indexation restored — capped at 2%	Re-indexation announced Nov 2022 but capped at 2% — below actual CPI in most subsequent years.
2025	Smith UCP	~\$1,940/mo	CDB clawback + rent increase net negative	Only province clawing back federal Canada Disability Benefit. \$220/mo community housing rent increase Oct 2025.
2026 (Jul 1)	Smith UCP	ADAP: ~\$1,700/mo*	Below 2018 NDP starting point	*With transition top-up. Underlying ADAP base ~\$1,500/mo when transition top-up expires Dec 31, 2027. The structural reversal of the 1979 founding bargain.

READING THE RATE TABLE

The table makes the structural argument visible at a glance. The Lougheed-era founding rate was pegged to senior pensions. The Klein-era freeze opened a real-term gap that no subsequent government has fully closed. The Notley statutory indexation (2018) was the only mechanism that would have closed the gap over time. It survived less than twelve months. The Smith era restored nominal indexation but capped it below actual CPI — and then layered the CDB clawback (July 2025) and the \$220/month rent increase (October 2025) on top of the cap. The 2026 ADAP transition reduces the base rate structurally below where it stood at the start of the Notley indexation. Forty-seven years of growth in the program's nominal value have not produced a single year in which a single Alberta on AISH was unambiguously better off, in real-term purchasing power, than a single Alberta on AISH was in 1979.

Caseload Trajectory, 1979 – 2026

The number of Albertans receiving AISH has grown by an order of magnitude across the forty-seven years this document covers — from approximately 3,500 at founding (per Donna Wood's archival research at AU Press) to 79,290 in September 2025. The growth reflects demographic expansion, broader recognition of qualifying conditions (particularly mental-health diagnoses), and the structural reality that disability is a permanent feature of any human population, not an anomaly of any particular era.

Year / Era	AISH Caseload	Growth Note
1979 Lougheed	~3,500*	Founding caseload (Donna Wood et al., AU Press estimates).
1992 End of Getty era	~15,000*	Steady growth as program matures and diagnostic categories broaden.
2004 Klein-era controversy	~31,500	Klein-era "yipping cowboy hats" controversy at this caseload.
2010 Stelmach	41,664	Open Alberta first reliable data point.
2015 Beginning of Notley	~48,000	Sustained growth in recognition of mental-health conditions as AISH-qualifying.
2019 End of Notley	~67,000	Fastest growth period documented in any single mandate.
2020 Kenney / pandemic	69,800	Growth temporarily slowed during COVID-19 diagnostic constraints.
2022 End of Kenney	~73,000	Pre-pandemic growth rate resumed.
2025 Smith (current)	79,290	The figure currently being processed through the ADAP transition. The approximately 79,290 directly affected. Indirect effects extend to the approximately 730,000 Albertans with one or more disability classifications.

*The 1979 and 1992 figures are archival estimates from academic sources; reliable Open Alberta data begins in the late 2000s. The fundamental observation — that AISH caseload has grown by approximately twenty-fold across the period this document covers — is not in dispute.

READING THE CASELOAD TABLE

The caseload growth is the structural reality every Alberta government has had to address, and the dimension on which the government framings most divergent from the lived-experience reality have most often appeared. Government communications frequently cite gross AISH spending as evidence of program adequacy. Caseload growth means that gross spending can rise even while per-recipient real-term purchasing power falls. The 79,290 figure is the population the 2026 ADAP transition directly affects. The disability community in Alberta is structurally larger than the AISH caseload, by approximately ten-fold. The structural template ADAP establishes will, by implication, apply to the broader 730,000.

Appeal Rights, 1979 – 2026

The single most-significant structural dimension on which 2025 differs from every preceding year in the forty-seven-year period this document covers. From the founding of AISH in 1979 through December 8, 2025, every Albertan denied an AISH benefit, terminated from the program, or subjected to a contested administrative decision had the right to seek review before the Citizens' Appeal Panel — an independent third-party body structured to provide the natural-justice protections (notice, hearing, recorded reasons, the right to introduce new evidence) that internal ministry review does not. The Panel was maintained across every Alberta government in the period: Lougheed, Getty, Klein, Stelmach, Redford, Hancock, Prentice, Notley, and Kenney. No premier removed it. Until December 9, 2025.

Era	Independent Appeal Status
Lougheed (1979)	Citizens' Appeal Panel established as independent third-party review for AISH decisions. Natural-justice protections embedded in program design.
Getty / Klein / Stelmach / Redford / Notley / Kenney (1985–2022)	Citizens' Appeal Panel jurisdiction maintained continuously across every government, regardless of party. No premier in 43 years removed appeal rights from AISH.
Smith UCP (2025)	Bill 12, Section 12.8 (December 9, 2025): Citizens' Appeal Panel jurisdiction removed for ADAP . Internal ministry review only. Charter Section 7 justiciable question raised. The first removal of independent appeal review for an Alberta disability program since program founding.

THE APPEAL-RIGHTS REMOVAL IS UNPRECEDENTED

Across nine Alberta governments and forty-six years (1979 to December 2025), no premier removed independent appeal review from an Alberta disability program. The 1979 founding included it. Every successor maintained it. Klein cut services. Kenney suspended indexation. Smith's predecessors did not, in any documented instance, remove the right to independent appeal. Bill 12 Section 12.8 (December 9, 2025) is the first documented removal of independent disability-program appeal review in Alberta history. **The structural argument this document has built across eight chapters culminates in this single legislative act.** Every preceding reduction was financial. This one is procedural. Financial reductions can be restored. Procedural reductions can be restored. But the precedent that independent appeal can be removed at all — once set — applies to every Alberta disability program, present and future. **This is what the campaign is mobilised to reverse.**

The Thesis, Stated in Full

The documented record this piece has constructed establishes the following:

1. Lougheed built the foundation

Between 1971 and 1985, the Peter Lougheed Progressive Conservative government built the foundational architecture of Alberta disability policy as it has existed for the past forty-seven years. The Heritage Savings Trust Fund (1976). AISH (1979). Services for the Handicapped (1972). The repeal of the Sexual Sterilization Act (1972). William Watson Lodge. The Alberta Bill of Rights. Section 15 of the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms (1982). The dignity framing. The senior-pension parity. The assured-income-not-welfare separation. The independent appeal review. Every structural element that the disability community in Alberta still depends on was either built or constitutionally protected during the Lougheed fourteen years.

2. No subsequent government has matched it — and most have reduced it

Across the twenty-seven years between Lougheed's retirement (1985) and his death (2012), and the fourteen years since, every successor government has been a net contributor to the trajectory this document records as downward. Getty halted the Heritage Fund transfer mechanism (1987). Klein froze AISH for over a decade and framed AISH recipients as suspect (1993–2006). Stelmach attempted a partial restoration that did not reach 1993 real-term parity (2006–2011). Redford announced the Michener Centre closure and the PDD service overhaul (2013). Prentice reversed Michener but did not undo the broader trajectory (2014). Notley achieved the only sustained restoration of the period — and saw it reversed within fifteen months by the government that succeeded her (2015–2019). Kenney suspended the Notley indexation through Bill 20 and relocated the definition of "severe handicap" out of legislation into regulation (2019). Smith used the regulatory framework Kenney's Bill 20 had constructed to build ADAP (2022–2026). Five of the nine governments in the period made net-negative contributions. Two made partial restorations. None matched what Lougheed had built.

3. The trajectory has accelerated

The structural reductions documented in this piece have not occurred at a constant rate. They have accelerated. The Klein-era reductions (1993–2006) unfolded across thirteen years. The Stelmach restoration (2007–2011) covered five years. The Notley restoration (2015–2019) covered four years. The Kenney reversal (2019) unfolded across six months. The Smith reversal (2022–2026) has accelerated further: November 2022 capped re-indexation, July 2025 CDB clawback, October 2025 rent increase, December 2025 Bill 12, May 2026 ADAP regulation, July 2026 ADAP transition — five distinct structural reductions in eighteen months. **Each successive era of dismantling has been faster than the one before.**

4. Partisan-aligned advocacy has not worked

The Notley NDP era produced the most positive disability-policy package in Alberta's modern history. The Kenney UCP government reversed it within fifteen months. The Stelmach PC era produced the only meaningful Klein-era restoration. Successor PC governments did not protect or extend it. The Prentice PC reversal of the Michener closure was confined to that single decision. Disability advocacy tied to the electoral fortunes of a particular party has, on the documented record this piece has constructed, not produced durable structural protection. Gains made under one party have proved reversible by the next. Statutory indexation

was reversed within twelve months. Service overhauls have been implemented over the objections of the affected community across multiple party rotations. **The disability community has not had a durable partisan ally in the forty-seven-year period this document covers.**

5. Statutory protection is necessary but not sufficient

The NDP Bill 26 (2018) was the most ambitious attempt in modern Alberta disability policy history to embed protection in statute. Rachel Notley's framing at introduction — *"Now that it's in the legislation, it would be much, much more difficult to be one of those discretionary things that doesn't happen"* — captured the structural theory of the indexation policy. The theory was tested in 2019 and proved insufficient. Kenney's UCP government reversed the indexation through Bill 20 (Fiscal Measures and Taxation Act) — an omnibus budget bill in which the disability-specific cut was one clause among many. Statutory protection did not prevent reversal. It only required the reversing government to use a different legislative instrument.

6. What remains is community-led representation

The documented record establishes that the disability community in Alberta has achieved structural protection only when it constructed the political conditions for that protection itself, independent of party affiliation. The 1979 founding of AISH was partly the product of Lougheed's political will; it was also the product of organised disability-community advocacy that pre-dated his government and was structurally larger than any single politician's contribution. The 2009 passage of Samantha's Law was the product of Velvet Martin's seven-year campaign, not of any Alberta government's initiative. The 2014 Prentice reversal of the Michener closure was the product of eighteen months of sustained pressure by Friends of the Michener Centre — pressure that produced the political conditions Prentice responded to. **Every documented structural improvement in Alberta disability policy across the forty-seven years this piece covers has had community-led advocacy as its precondition.** Government action has been the lagging indicator, not the leading one.

Why Partisan-Aligned Advocacy Has Failed

The disability community in Alberta has spent forty-seven years cycling between the political parties that have, in succession, occupied the Premier's office. The pattern across all of those years is consistent enough that it warrants explicit analysis.

When a government sympathetic to disability supports has taken office, the community's strategic instinct has been to align with it — to provide political cover for the sympathetic government's policy adjustments, to soften criticism of the sympathetic government's omissions, to defer the more ambitious policy objectives to a later mandate when fiscal conditions might improve. When an unsympathetic government has taken office, the community's strategic instinct has been to wait it out — to engage in defensive advocacy, to limit further reductions, to preserve as much of the previous government's gains as possible until the political pendulum swings back. Both strategies have been individually rational. **The cumulative effect of cycling between them has been catastrophic.**

Three specific failure modes are documented across the eight phases of this piece:

Failure mode 1: Sympathetic governments don't fully deliver

The Notley NDP government held a majority in the Legislature for four years. It delivered the most ambitious package of disability-policy reforms in modern Alberta history. It also, on honest accounting, did not pass comprehensive accessibility legislation, did not complete the PDD program restructure that its own review had identified as necessary, did not implement the AISH indexation it had legislated (the first indexed increase under NDP Bill 26 was scheduled for after the election the NDP lost), and waited until the final year of its mandate to introduce the indexation legislation at all. The structural reasons for these omissions are documented in Phase Six. The point here is structural: even the most sympathetic Alberta government of the period did not fully deliver on the policy framework the community needed.

Failure mode 2: Unsympathetic governments reverse faster than sympathetic governments build

The Notley NDP took three and a half years to enact Bill 26 (2018). The Kenney UCP took six months to suspend it. Asymmetry in this direction is the structural default of the policy environment. Building durable policy is procedurally harder than reversing it. The reversal mechanism (omnibus legislation, regulatory amendment, Order in Council) is structurally faster than the construction mechanism (legislative debate, community consultation, implementation infrastructure). **The disability community's gains, in any given mandate, are typically reversible in roughly half the time it took to achieve them.** Across the forty-seven-year period, this asymmetry has compounded.

Failure mode 3: Cumulative drift is invisible inside any single mandate

No single Alberta government has, in any single mandate, executed a reduction large enough to mobilise sustained public opposition that would have produced subsequent electoral consequences. Each reduction has been incremental enough to be characterised as fiscal-discipline-as-usual, framed in language that minimised its visibility, embedded inside larger legislative or budget packages that distributed the political pressure across multiple advocacy fronts. The cumulative drift across forty-seven years is the substance of this document. But the drift, by its nature, has been invisible to any single voter in any single election. **The pattern is only visible when the full forty-seven-year record is constructed and laid out together — which is what this document has now done.**

The Case for Community-Led Representation

The structural alternative to partisan-aligned advocacy is what this document, and the campaign that published it, terms **community-led representation**: an organised, persistent, party-independent advocacy structure that maintains its analytical and political coherence across electoral cycles, that does not defer to the priorities of any particular party, and that builds the political conditions for legislative change rather than waiting for those conditions to arise from a sympathetic government's initiative.

What community-led representation looks like in practice

Several elements have already been constructed by the ADSB campaign in its first four months of operation, and several elements remain to be built. The documented examples of what community-led representation has accomplished in Alberta's recent history:

- **Samantha's Law (2009).** Velvet Martin's seven-year campaign produced a statutory amendment that no Alberta government would have initiated. The Stelmach government enacted the amendment because Velvet Martin had constructed the political conditions for the enactment. This is the model.
- **The Prentice Michener reversal (September 2014).** Friends of the Michener Centre — including Lee Kvern, the Kvern family, and the broader community-led organisation — sustained eighteen months of public pressure that made the Hancock government's continuation of the closure politically unsustainable. Prentice's reversal was the response to the political conditions the community had constructed.
- **The 2017 unanimous passage of Bill 205 — Advocate for Persons with Disabilities Act.** Sandra Jansen's private member's bill became law because the disability community had constructed the political conditions for unanimous support across party lines. The Office of the Advocate continues to operate under the UCP government — a Notley-era construction the UCP has not dismantled, because the political cost of dismantling it would exceed the fiscal benefit.
- **The 2026 ADSB municipal coalition.** Six municipal governments — Calgary, Edmonton, Lethbridge, Camrose, Red Deer, Medicine Hat — have engaged formally with the ADSB framework, recognising that downstream costs of provincial disability-program reductions fall on municipalities. The coalition is structurally smaller than what is ultimately required, but it represents the kind of cross-jurisdictional alliance community-led representation produces.

What community-led representation requires

The campaign that published this document operates on the following structural premises:

- **Documentation-first, evidence-driven.** Every claim made by the campaign is anchored to a primary source — government regulation, Hansard, Open Alberta data, peer-reviewed academic research, contemporaneous reporting. The campaign does not advance positions it cannot defend on the documented record.
- **Party-independent.** The campaign does not endorse, oppose, or align with any political party. It documents what each government has done and continues to do. Phase Six of this piece is the most positive era's documentation. Phase Three is the most negative era's documentation. Both chapters operate to the same evidentiary standard.

- **Cross-issue.** Disability supports cannot be separated from housing, healthcare, accessibility, employment, child welfare, transportation, or education — every one of which is documented as a structural component of the broader policy environment. The campaign engages across all of them rather than limiting itself to any single dimension.
- **Public-record-building.** Every campaign document, every Tier 1 submission, every coalition partnership exists to construct a public evidentiary record that successive Alberta governments cannot disclaim. The record exists. The community can point to it. Successive governments will be asked to explain themselves against it.
- **Community-anchored.** The campaign's name is The Alberta Disability System Breakdown. Its anchor is in St. Albert, Alberta. Its primary audience is the approximately 730,000 Albertans with disabilities and their families, allies, advocates, service providers, and elected representatives. Its structure does not depend on any single individual, organisation, or government for its continued operation.

The Closing Argument

Peter Lougheed built the foundation of Alberta disability policy on January 1, 1979. The structure he built was foundational greatness. The forty-seven years that followed have been, in the language this document chose deliberately as its title, a betrayal — the sharpest non-defamatory word in English for what the documented record establishes. Not corruption, which carries legal specificity this document does not assert. Not failure, which is morally neutral. Not decline, which is structurally passive. **Betrayal** — because the structure Lougheed built was a promise, and every successor Alberta government has, in varying degrees, broken some part of that promise.

Lougheed himself understood the promise. He used the words *dignity* and *independence* as the design criteria for AISH at its founding. He kept those words public for the rest of his life. The Lethbridge Herald's open letter to Premier Smith in March 2026, cited in Phase One, captures the founding framing precisely: "*Premier Lougheed understood that we each live just one incident away from a severely disabling event.*" One incident away. The campaign uses the same framing — *one accident away* — in its 2026 teach-ins. The continuity is not accidental. It is the community rediscovering the founding principle and defending it against the governments that have, in varying degrees, abandoned it.

The disability community in Alberta in 2026 is approximately 730,000 people. Approximately 79,290 of them currently receive AISH. All of them — every Albertan with one or more disability classifications, every parent of a disabled child, every spouse of a disabled adult, every family member, every support worker, every service provider, every ally — are, on the documented record this piece has constructed, structurally exposed to the trajectory this document describes. The 2026 ADAP transition is the most direct application of that trajectory to the AISH-receiving population. But the structural template ADAP establishes applies to every Alberta disability program. The Family Support for Children with Disabilities program. The Persons with Developmental Disabilities program. Special Needs Assistance. The Alberta Seniors Benefit. Income Support for the broader low-income population. All of them operate within the same regulatory framework that Bill 20 (2019) restructured and that Bill 12 (2025) extended. The ADAP transition is the visible application. The structural template is the structural application.

The documented record this piece has constructed establishes that **no Alberta government, of any party, has been a durable enough ally to make partisan-aligned advocacy a viable strategy for the disability community.** The Lougheed era was the founding. Every successor has been a contributor to the trajectory — most negatively, two positively, none sufficiently to reverse the downward arc the documented record establishes.

What remains is community-led representation. Documentation-first. Evidence-driven. Party-independent. Cross-issue. Public-record-building. Community-anchored. Persistent across electoral cycles in a way that no single party has been, and no single sympathetic government has been able to be.

This document is one part of that representation. It is one of approximately thirty primary documents produced by the ADSB campaign in its first four months of operation. It will be one of approximately sixty primary documents by the campaign's first year. Every document the campaign produces is in the public domain — free to share, free to print, free to post — because community-led representation is structurally incompatible with any form of access restriction. The work belongs to the community it represents. The community can use the work to make whatever case the community needs to make, in whatever forum, at whatever scale, on whatever timeline. The campaign exists to provide the analytic and documentary infrastructure. The community provides the political weight.

To the disabled Albertan reading this document

You are not alone. Approximately 730,000 Albertans share at least some part of your structural situation. Approximately 79,290 share the most acute part of it. The documented record this piece has constructed exists because your experience deserves to be on the record, not because the record itself will change your circumstances. The record is the foundation. What follows the record is up to all of us.

To the family member, the caregiver, the ally

You have been carrying weight that the structures documented in this piece should have been carrying. The structures were built to share the weight. The structures have, in varying degrees, abandoned that responsibility. The documented record establishes how, when, and under which governments the abandonment occurred. The record does not, by itself, restore the structures. It establishes the ground on which restoration can begin.

To the elected representative reading this document

Every elected representative in Alberta is on the public record on the actions documented in this piece. The voting records, the press releases, the Hansard transcripts, the cabinet memoranda are all primary sources. The community will be reading them. The community will be holding the record against your future actions. **The choice of which side of the documented record your name appears on is still available to you.** The Stelmach government's 2009 Samantha's Law amendment is on the positive side. The Kenney government's 2019 Bill 20 is on the negative side. The Prentice government's 2014 Michener reversal is on the positive side. The Smith government's 2025 Bill 12 Section 12.8 is on the negative side. The pattern is bipartisan. The choice is individual. The community has the documented record. The community will be using it.

To Peter Lougheed

Peter Lougheed died on September 13, 2012, in the Calgary hospital that bears his name. He cannot read this document. He spent the last seventeen years of his life publicly arguing that the structures he built were being drawn down rather than added to. He named the structural mechanism ("selling the house to pay for the groceries"). He named the structural failure mode ("thinking like a manager rather than thinking like an owner"). He named the corrective principle ("*You have to manage the resource and that means to manage it with good public policy*"). He did not name the disability community specifically in any documented interview the campaign has located. He did not need to. The principle he kept restating applies to the disability community with the same force it applies to the Heritage Savings Trust Fund.

He was correct. He was correct for fourteen years he served as Premier. He was correct for twenty-seven years he watched his successors fail to maintain what he had built. He was correct for fourteen years after his death. He will remain correct for as long as the principle he stated applies to the wealth Alberta extracts from the ground and the wealth Alberta neglects from the people who live on it.

The disability community in Alberta does not need a new principle. The principle Lougheed stated in 2012 still applies. What the community needs is the structural representation that will hold successive governments to that principle, regardless of party, regardless of fiscal conditions, regardless of electoral cycles. **The campaign that published this document exists to begin constructing that representation.** What this document hopes the reader takes from it is the recognition that the construction is necessary, that the documented record has now been built, and that the work continues.

THE CLOSING SENTENCE

From greatness to betrayal. From assured income to conditional support. From appeal rights to internal review only. From senior parity to a \$200/month base-rate reduction. From dignity and independence to employment activity and opportunity to earn. From the most-positive disability-policy package in modern Alberta history to the most-comprehensive disability-policy restructure since 1979 — in forty-seven years. **The trajectory is real. The trajectory is documented. The trajectory is reversible. The community is the reversal mechanism. The campaign is one of the tools. The record is now built. The work continues.**

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — Advocate

St. Albert, Alberta • May 2026 • Phase Nine — Synthesis

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